Steven Landers

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PRINCIPAL ENGINEER & TECHNICAL LEADER

Distributed Systems | Financial-Market Infrastructure | Security | Agentic Engineering

Principal-level engineer and technical leader with 20 years building and scaling distributed, security-sensitive systems across blockchain, regulated financial infrastructure, fraud detection, telecommunications, and cloud platforms. Led the architecture and implementation of Sei's parallelized EVM and its multi-proposer consensus platform, designed for roughly 200,000 transactions per second. Currently developing centralized exchange infrastructure in preparation for Designated Contract Market and Futures Commission Merchant license applications; previously helped grow Forta, a $23 million a16z-backed decentralized security network, from a laptop prototype to roughly 12,000 nodes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sei Labs 2023–Present

L7 Engineer (Manager), Consensus & Execution Team

Centralized Exchange Platform

- Led hands-on development and deployment of a centralized exchange platform in preparation for Designated Contract Market and Futures Commission Merchant license applications, spanning trading systems, market operations, security controls, and production readiness.
- Translated regulatory, operational, and risk-management requirements into technical architecture, system controls, and engineering processes.
- Developed the platform with an agentic Claude workflow that encodes exchange-specific domain knowledge in reusable skills, guardrails, and automated validation, while retaining direct ownership of architecture, security, code review, and production deployment.

Sei Giga

- Led the design, prototyping, development, and ongoing rollout of Sei Giga, a multi-proposer blockchain architecture based on a modified Autobahn consensus protocol, designed for approximately 5 gigagas per second (roughly 200,000 transactions per second) under target workloads.
- Led a five-engineer consensus and execution team responsible for incrementally delivering the architecture to mainnet.
- Drove technical design across consensus, execution, performance, and production rollout; contributed to published research on multi-proposer architecture and MEV (see Publications).

Sei Parallelized EVM

- Designed and implemented Block-STM parallel transaction execution on top of Sei's Cosmos-based EVM, delivering the first parallelized EVM implementation in the Sei ecosystem.
- Designed deterministic state-conflict detection, transaction validation, and conflict-resolution mechanisms, with sequential fallback to preserve correctness and mitigate pathological conflict and denial-of-service scenarios.
- Worked across execution, storage, scheduling, validation, and consensus integration to move the design from prototype into production.

OpenZeppelin / Forta 2020–2023

Director of Development / CTO, Forta

Forta

- Served as principal architect and technical leader for Forta, a decentralized transaction-monitoring and threat-detection network that raised $23 million from a16z, growing it from a laptop proof of concept into a production network of approximately 12,000 nodes.
- Scaled the platform to more than 13,000 subscribers and more than 900 detection bots continuously monitoring transactions across Ethereum, BNB Smart Chain, Avalanche, Polygon, Arbitrum, and Optimism.
- Led a nine-engineer team responsible for architecture, technical design reviews, roadmaps, and performance management; helped deliver the network protocol, cloud infrastructure, blockchain integrations, token launch, airdrop, indexing systems, and developer platform.

OpenZeppelin Defender

- Principal architect for Defender, a security-first DevSecOps platform for Web3 projects, designed as a scalable AWS serverless application supporting transaction operations, monitoring, automation, and blockchain infrastructure.
- Built systems for reliable JSON-RPC provider access, transaction retry and fee repricing, automated operational tasks, and transaction monitoring.
- Developed the decentralized monitoring proof of concept that became Forta and transitioned to leading Forta full time after funding.

Bishop Fox 2019–2020

Principal Engineer & Software Manager

- Managed a five-engineer team building a high-scale continuous attack-surface and vulnerability-detection platform for Fortune 500 customers.
- Designed and launched cloud-asset ingestion into security analytics systems, and built a domain-discovery system using SSL certificate analysis, WHOIS data, and remote asset lookups.

Netvote (side venture) 2017–2019

Co-Founder & Technical Director

- Co-founded an anonymous, tamper-resistant voting platform built on Ethereum and other distributed-ledger technologies, designing a protocol that integrated blockchain-based voting with modern election processes.
- Delivered production elections with Govurn, including the RChain cooperative board election (2018).

Pindrop 2016–2019

Software Architect

- Architected fraud-detection and authentication systems used by major banks and enterprise call centers, helping evolve Pindrop's data architecture toward approximately three billion analyzed calls per year.
- Led a small team that designed, built, and launched Cloud Protect, a cloud-based fraud platform adopted by multiple large financial customers.
- Designed end-to-end capabilities for real-time fraud detection, model management, and machine-learning processing pipelines; led cross-functional efforts to scale concurrent call-processing capacity.

Vocalocity / Vonage 2010–2016

Director of Software Architecture

- Promoted from Software Engineer through Development Manager and Director of Development to Director of Software Architecture; led teams of as many as 21 software engineers and UX professionals.
- Helped scale Vocalocity's proprietary business communications platform before and after its acquisition by Vonage, coordinating distributed teams in Atlanta, New Jersey, and Tel Aviv; designed systems for provisioning, billing, authentication, emergency calling, call-event processing, and telecommunications routing.

Earlier Experience

- **CGI Group, Consultant** | 2006–2010: Built and operated production telecommunications, billing, portal, and set-top-box systems; began career carrying a 24/7 production pager for a major telecommunications provider.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Systems: Distributed systems, consensus protocols, parallel execution, exchange infrastructure, blockchain architecture, security platforms, fraud detection, real-time and event-driven architecture, high-availability systems

Languages & platforms: Go, Python, TypeScript, Java, Solidity, AWS, Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker, PostgreSQL, MySQL, DynamoDB, Kafka, Redis, Elasticsearch

AI-assisted development: Agentic engineering with Claude, including reusable skills, task-specific workflows, automated validation, and human architectural review

EDUCATION

MBA, University of Georgia, 2012 | **BS, Computer Science**, University of Georgia, 2005

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS AND PROJECTS

- Sei Giga: Multi-Proposer Blockchain (arxiv.org/abs/2505.14914)
- MEV in Multi-Proposer Blockchains (arxiv.org/abs/2511.13080)
- Forta: github.com/forta-network | docs.forta.network | forta.org